

Gary Dobkin - Startup AI Leadership Proof Brief

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The Problem I Solve

Most AI products fail in production because they stop at prompts and demos. Real business workflows need state, contracts, tool boundaries, validation, observability, approval gates, and evidence that can survive customer, compliance, and executive scrutiny.

My work is focused on building that operating layer: production AI workflows that execute defined roles, return structured outputs, preserve traceability, and stay useful when real workflows become messy.

What I Built

Paput.ai / EUCompli.ai - A Rails 8 compliance and AI workflow platform for GDPR and EU AI Act domains.

- Built a working Rails 8 control plane with PostgreSQL, Solid Queue, authentication, authorization, MCP transport, API documentation, audit logs, and deployment-ready architecture.
- Built quick/full scan flows with subscription gates, structured phase outputs, persisted findings, regional records, compliance tests, implementation records, telemetry, and observability.
- Designed production AI workflows with defined roles, schema-bound outputs, traceable tool calls, deterministic tests, visible state, evidence bundles, and human approval gates.
- Built internal operator workflows for support, sales, CRM, evidence capture, recovery, and approval-aware AI operations so product work stayed tied to real business execution.
- Designed the path from Rails/Solid Queue orchestration into Firecracker-backed isolated compute for heavier analysis workloads, higher scan volume, and concurrent AI execution while preserving contracts, state, validation gates, monitoring, and reporting.

Why It Matters

The value is the operating architecture behind AI systems that need to be reliable, reviewable, and deployable:

- **State:** durable task and phase state instead of one-off prompt execution.
- **Contracts:** structured outputs and predictable handoffs between AI workflows, tools, and humans.
- **Evidence:** persisted artifacts, audit logs, compliance records, and explainable findings.
- **Controls:** approval gates, risk gates, subscription gates, watchdogs, and recovery checkpoints.
- **Observability:** telemetry, queue visibility, costs, stale job detection, and runtime metrics.
- **Deployment posture:** container/cloud deployment today, isolated compute path for heavier workloads.

Relevant Leadership Context

- Founded and exited a 12-year MSP serving 50+ AAHA/AVMA-oriented veterinary hospitals with under 1% churn.
- Built customer success at Perch Security through acquisition, reaching 1.7% annual churn, 96%+ CSAT, and 97% NPS.

- Directed 26-person global security deployment operations at ConnectWise across SIEM, IDS/IPS, EDR/MDR, US/EMEA/APAC, and 200+ monthly projects.

Best Fit

I am most useful where a company needs someone who can define the product, build the first reliable system, operate directly with customers, and turn AI from a prototype into a governed workflow platform.